

Jesus, Priceless Treasure

- 1 Jesus, priceless treasure,
source of purest pleasure,
truest friend to me:
ah, how long in anguish
shall my spirit languish,
yearning, Lord, for thee.
Thine I am, O spotless Lamb!
I will suffer naught to hide thee,
naught I ask beside thee.
- 2 In thine arms I rest me;
foes who would molest me
cannot reach me here.
Though the earth be shaking,
ev'ry heart be quaking,
Jesus calms my fear.
Lightnings flash and thunders crash;
yet, though sin and hell assail me,
Jesus will not fail me.
- 3 Satan, I defy thee;
death, I now decry thee;
fear, I bid thee cease.
World, thou shalt not harm me
nor thy threats alarm me
while I sing of peace.
God's great pow'r guards ev'ry hour;
earth and all its depths adore him,
silent bow before him.
- 4 Hence with earthly treasure!
Thou art all my pleasure,
Jesus, all my choice.
Hence, thou empty glory!
Naught to me thy story,
told with tempting voice.
Pain or loss or shame or cross
shall not from my Savior move me,
since he deigns to love me.
- 5 Hence, all fear of sadness!
For the Lord of gladness,
Jesus, enters in.
Those who love the Father,
though the storms may gather,
still have peace within.
Yea, whate'er I must here bear,
thou art still my purest pleasure,
Jesus priceless treasure.

Words: Johann Franck, 1653; tr. Catherine Winkworth, 1863

Music: German melody; arr. J. S. Bach, 1723

Tune: JESU, MEINE FREUDE · 6.6.5.6.6.5.7.8.6 · Scripture: 1 Peter 2:7

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